ARTH THAKKAR

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Identity and Access Management | Microsoft 365 and Endpoint Management | Infrastructure Site Lead | AI and Automation

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior IT professional with 5+ years of experience across 4 enterprise organizations and environments of up to 20,000+ users, specializing in identity and access management on Microsoft Entra ID alongside end-user computing and site infrastructure. Experienced in the full identity lifecycle, privileged access with Entra PIM, access reviews and access packages, Conditional Access and SOX ITGC access audits, backed by completed SC-300 training. Primary onsite face of IT for corporate head offices, delivering white-glove support to C-suite leaders, and an AI and automation champion using Claude, AWS Bedrock and PowerShell.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Identity and Compliance:** Owned the identity lifecycle for 5,000+ identities, co-own monthly SOX ITGC access audits for 10,000+ users with zero missed audit cycles, and moved admin roles to just-in-time access with Entra PIM.
- **Process Improvement:** Cut provisioning errors by 40%, access incidents by 35% and triage time by 25%; sustained 99.9% uptime for 10+ Microsoft 365 and Azure clients.
- **Service Excellence:** Resolved 1,000+ incidents per month at 100% SLA compliance in ServiceNow and sustained 95% customer satisfaction supporting partners and senior leaders.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Identity Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Active Directory, Hybrid Identity (Entra Connect Sync, Cloud Sync), Users, Groups and Dynamic Groups, B2B Guest Access, Administrative Units, RBAC and Custom Roles, Least Privilege, Joiner-Mover-Leaver
- **Authentication and Access:** Conditional Access, MFA, Passwordless (Windows Hello for Business, FIDO2, Authenticator), Self-Service Password Reset, Entra ID Protection (User and Sign-in Risk), Zero Trust
- **Identity Governance:** Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Access Reviews, Entitlement Management and Access Packages, Lifecycle Workflows, Terms of Use, Sign-in and Audit Logs
- **Application Access:** Enterprise Applications, SSO (SAML, OpenID Connect, OAuth 2.0), App Registrations, User and Admin Consent, Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps
- **Microsoft 365 and Endpoint:** Microsoft 365, Exchange Online, SharePoint, Teams, Microsoft Intune, SCCM, JAMF Pro, Apple Business Manager, Microsoft Defender, EDR, Endpoint Security
- **Infrastructure:** Windows Server, Patching and Monitoring, Backup and Restore (Barracuda, Veeam), Physical Security and Badge Access, Networking (Switch Racking, Fabric Networks, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Wireless APs, Ekahau)
- **End-User Computing:** Windows 10/11, macOS, Executive (VIP) Support, Software Testing and Deployment, Microsoft Teams Rooms, Zoom Rooms, User Training
- **ITSM and Governance:** ITIL, ServiceNow (Incident, Problem, Change, Request, CMDB, HAM Pro), SOX ITGC Audit Evidence, Access Certification, Segregation of Duties, Evergreen Refresh, Vendor Management
- **AI and Automation:** Anthropic Claude, Claude Code, AWS Bedrock, LLM API Integration, Prompt Engineering, Human-in-the-Loop AI Validation, PowerShell, ServiceNow Workflows

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems Specialist (Infrastructure Site Lead) **Sep 2025 – Present**
Extreme Networks *Toronto, ON*

- Serve as senior onsite technical resource and primary face of IT for the Canadian office, delivering white-glove VIP support to senior leadership and translating complex IT issues for business leaders.
- Co-own monthly SOX ITGC access audits for 10,000+ users, collecting access evidence and governing hybrid AD and Entra ID with least privilege.
- Drive AI, data and automation use cases using Anthropic Claude, Claude Code, PowerShell and ServiceNow workflows, with human-in-the-loop validation, to improve efficiency and decision-making.
- Support Windows and macOS devices and local applications, resolving incidents through ServiceNow incident, problem and change management with root cause analysis.
- Administer site Windows servers, including monitoring, patching and maintenance; monitor local backups and perform data restorations to confirm recovery readiness.
- Act as onsite network lead with no local NetOps staff: rack and install switches, connect edge switches to core across the fabric network, validate desk jacks and keep wireless access points online.
- Manage physical security and badge access systems with Security and Facilities teams, keeping local infrastructure secure and compliant with global IT standards and reporting exceptions to the Regional IT Services Manager.
- Own Teams Rooms and Zoom Rooms for onsite and hybrid meetings and town halls; test and deploy software releases before rollout and drive adoption through user training.
- Run Evergreen PC, network and server refresh with 5 vendors (Dell, Apple, Lenovo, SHI, CDW), keeping asset records in ServiceNow HAM Pro and CMDB reconciled across Intune, JAMF Pro and SCCM.

Regional Technology Specialist (IT Operations Site Lead) **Aug 2024 – Sep 2025**
McCain Foods Limited *Toronto, ON*

- Administered Microsoft Entra Privileged Identity Management (PIM) for Entra ID and Azure roles, converting standing admin access to eligible, just-in-time activation with approval, MFA, justification and time limits.
- Built Entra ID Governance access packages and recurring access reviews for privileged roles, groups and guest users.
- Acted as primary technology representative for the Toronto head office, supporting C-suite and global executives in a 20,000-employee global organization.
- Served as sole liaison between global IT infrastructure teams and Canadian business units, coordinating cross-regional incidents and driving adoption through user training.
- Designed and enforced Intune compliance, configuration and app-protection policies for the corporate iOS fleet, from Apple Business Manager enrollment through retirement.
- Managed asset inventory, Evergreen refresh, vendor pricing and warranty claims; led technical delivery of executive town halls and Teams Rooms meetings, and completed an Ekahau wireless site survey for a new access point installation.

System Support Specialist II (Technical Site Lead) **May 2023 – Aug 2024**
Walmart Global Tech *Toronto, ON*

- Owned the identity lifecycle for 5,000+ identities within a 20,000+ user hybrid environment, collaborating with global support teams.
- Reduced provisioning errors by 40% by standardizing joiner-mover-leaver processes and building account and group templates adopted for new site launches.
- Resolved 1,000+ incidents per month across identity, endpoint, hardware and network platforms at 100% SLA compliance in ServiceNow; improved global triage efficiency by 25% through root cause analyses.
- Led inventory audits in ServiceNow CMDB, secured Windows and macOS endpoints with SCCM and JAMF Pro, and delivered hybrid town halls at the Bentonville head office.

Information Technology Analyst **Apr 2022 – May 2023**
Deloitte *Toronto, ON*

- Ran joiner-mover-leaver processes for a 10,000-user practice, coordinating hardware, software and badge access with Facilities and revoking access promptly at exit.
- Supported partners and senior leaders on laptops, peripherals, Microsoft 365 and Teams meeting rooms, sustaining 95% customer satisfaction.
- Rebuilt the knowledge base and escalation procedures and trained staff on applications and security practices; automated Tier 2 and Tier 3 access resolution with PowerShell.

Systems Administrator (Identity and Access Management) **Oct 2021 – Mar 2022**
Audcomp – Managed Service Provider (MSP) *Ancaster, ON*

- Supported 10+ MSP clients across government, enterprise, transportation and non-profit sectors, including the City of Hamilton, City of Burlington, ZipRecruiter, Vision Truck, Black Creek and church organizations.
- Architected client Microsoft 365 and Azure configurations, licensing and identity, reducing access-related incidents by 35% by redesigning roles and security groups across multi-tenant environments at 99.9% uptime.
- Designed and managed client backup and recovery with Barracuda, Veeam and Microsoft cloud backup; ran quarterly backup audits and cloud-to-cloud restores to verify recovery readiness.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender and EDR baselines to meet government audit framework requirements for public-sector clients.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Identity and Access Administrator (SC-300): full training and theory completed, certification exam pending
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), 2024
- Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900), 2023

PROJECTS

AI Cloud Lead, MISE – AI-Powered Inventory Management Platform **May 2026 – Jul 2026**
UMGC Capstone *github.com/UMGCCAPSTONE*

- Built a restaurant inventory platform with a 6-person team (React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Docker) featuring Claude menu recommendations on AWS Bedrock; designed the Prisma data model, migrations and seed dataset.
- Developed the React inventory add, edit and delete flow, CSV export and dashboard API endpoints with Vitest and Jest tests; the instructor called it one of the most innovative projects in 10 years.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science **Aug 2026**
University of Maryland Global Campus | GPA 3.88/4.00 | Dean's List (four terms) | Completed while working full-time

Diploma, Computer Systems Technician – Network Systems **Apr 2021**
Mohawk College, Hamilton, ON